Gaseous agents

- Formaldehyde
- Ethylene oxide
- Glutaraldehyde
- Propiolactone

Disadvantage: These gas may cause irritant to the eyes, and mucous membranes and un wanted odors.

6.6.1.6 Low temperature:

Cold has the effect of decreasing or completely stopping the growth of bacteria constant freezing will destroy and inhibit the growth of bacteria.

In freeze condition the organisms growth may be delayed or inhibited. The organisms can be destroyed often is freeze conditions.

Principles to be observed:

1. All articles contaminated with blood, feces, pus, sputum or other substances must be rinsed with cold water to prevent coagulation of protein material.
2. Use soap and water for cleaning the instruments and use a brush whenever necessary.
3. Allow sufficient time for articles to be disinfected or sterilized by physical or chemical agents.
4. It is importance to select the right disinfectant, the right strength and the right time.
5. Use the right procedure to render instruments and other articles safe for further use in order to prevent the spread of infection.

6.7 Universal Precaution

Definition:

Universal precaution is an approach to infection control to treat all human blood and certain human body fluids as if they were known to be infectious for HIV, HBV and other blood borne pathogens.

Need for universal precautions: -

- Use barrier protection to prevent skin and mucous membrane contact with blood or other body fluids.
- Wear gloves to prevent contact with blood, infectious material or other, potentially contaminated surfaces or items.
- Wear face protection if blood or bodily fluid droplets may be generated during a procedure.
- Wear protective clothing if blood or bodily fluid may be splashed during a procedure.
- Wash hands and skin immediately and thoroughly if contaminated with blood as body fluid.
- Wash hands immediately after gloves are removed.
- Use care when using or handling sharp instruments and needles. Place used sharps in labeled, punctured resistance container.
- If you have sustained an exposure or puncture wound, immediately flush the exposed and notify your supervisor.

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